SENSay

SENSay: the product guide

What it does, who it is for, and how it should feel to use

Audience	Schools, services, partners and anyone who wants the whole picture
Version	October 2026
Website	sensay.uk
Contact	hello@sensay.uk

1 SENSay in one page

SENSay is a communication app for pre-verbal and non-verbal children, and a record of what they communicate for the adults around them. It has five parts, each built for one person, all reading and writing the same record.

Part	Who it is for	What it does
The board	The child	Speaks for them: 43 core words in fixed places, phrases, word lists, topics, a keyboard and their own words and photos
The family app	Parents and carers	Messages by email and text, patterns over time, reports, and sharing with school and therapists
The school side	Teachers, teaching assistants and SENCOs	Today's priorities, evidence against targets, review packs and Section B drafts, teaching aids
The clinician side	Therapists and clinicians	A shared caseload, appointment summaries and notes with advice for home and school
SENSay Connect	AAC services and schools with other devices	Usage from TD Snap, Grid 3 and other systems, across a whole caseload, over months

All of it runs at app.sensay.uk in any modern browser, on a tablet, phone or computer, with the same account. The app is built for iPad, Android and the web from one code base, and moves to the App Store and Google Play in 2027.

2 How it should feel

Every design decision comes back to one test: would William, and the adults around him, find this calm, quick and trustworthy?

- **Nothing moves.** Words keep their place on every page, at every level, after every change. Children learn a board by position, and moving a word undoes weeks of learning.
- **Big, clear and calm.** Large tiles, symbols with plain labels in Nunito, colour by word type (yellow people, green actions, blue describing words, orange things, pink social words, red no and stop), and no adverts, badges or animations on the child's screen.
- **The essentials are always there.** Yes, no, stop, help, pain and toilet sit in the same strip on every page.
- **Fast.** A tap speaks at once. The board works offline and sends when the connection returns.
- **Adults are kept out of the child's way.** Settings, edit mode and leaving the board sit behind an adult gate: press and hold for two seconds, then answer a sum.
- **Honest.** The child's words always lead. Anything SENSay or the AI adds is labelled as a suggestion, never as the child's words.



The board on a tablet: core words in fixed places, the always-on strip, and a message being built

3 The child's board

Section	Contents
Core words	43 high-frequency words and 5 folders in 48 fixed places: people, actions, describing words, questions and little words
Quick talk	Ready-made phrases, feelings and social language
Word lists	32 lists: food, drinks, animals, people, body, health, clothes, home, places, school, toys, transport, colours, time, weather and more
Topics	36 everyday situations, from arriving at school to bath time, the dentist and the trampoline
Keyboard	Letters, numbers and word prediction that learns from the child's own words first
My words	The family's own pages, photos, videos and favourites

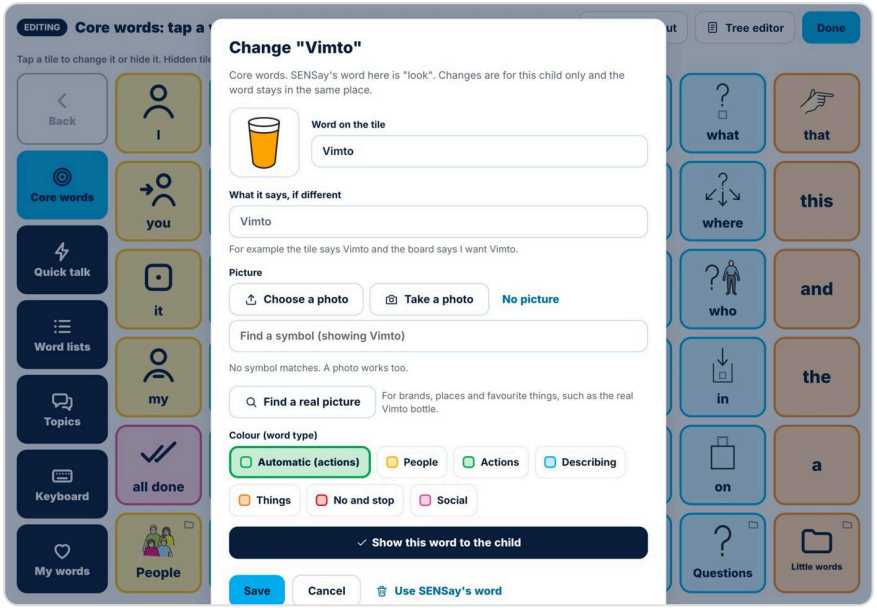
Building a message. Words build up in the message bar and are spoken as they are tapped. Word forms turn want into wants or wanted. Search finds any word and opens its page with the word outlined. Send speaks the whole message and sends it.

Voices. Seven character voices (young girl, young boy, little one, older girl, older boy, woman, man), each tuned from the best voice on the device, with speed and pitch.

Symbols and pictures. Mulberry symbols (3,400, UK-made, openly licensed) on every built-in word. Families add their own photos, or find a real picture: SENSay searches open picture libraries and Open Food Facts for branded food and drink, and an AI judge picks the clearest picture. Vimto gets the real bottle.

4 Making the board fit the child

Control	What it does
Levels	First words (about 16 core words), Growing (about 32) or Full (all 43). Hidden words leave empty cells so nothing moves when the level goes up
Sections	Switch Quick talk, Word lists, Topics, Keyboard or My words on or off
Word editor	Rename any word, change what it says, change its symbol or photo, change its colour, hide it, or add a word to an empty cell. "Use SENSay's word" undoes it
Profile on the board	People, favourite foods, drinks, places and activities from the child's profile appear in empty cells on the matching pages, with the right picture
Restrictions	Allergies and food rules hide matching words everywhere; if restrictions cannot be loaded, food and drink stay hidden until they can
Layout	Grid size, symbol size, labels on or off, and which page the board opens on
Tree editor	Build and order the family's own pages under My words



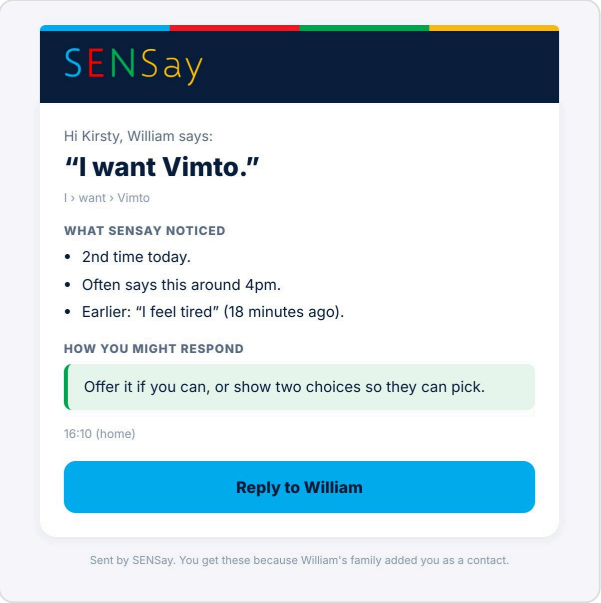
The word editor: change a word, its picture or its colour, and it stays in the same place

5 The intelligence behind each message

Every message carries a brief to the adults who receive it, built without AI:

1. **What the child said,** in their own words, first.
2. **What SENSay noticed** from the child's last 30 days: how many times today, the time they usually say it, new words, what came just before, and whether a burst looks like play.
3. **How you might respond:** one practical suggestion, chosen for urgency, food and drink, feelings or activities.

Urgent messages (pain, illness, breathing, help, feeling unsafe, being hurt or touched, the toilet, stop) are decided on the server from the words and the board path, always sent at once, marked urgent and never rate-limited. **Repeats** of the same non-urgent message within 10 minutes are not sent again, and non-urgent messages are limited to 30 an hour. Each email has a Reply link; the reply is read aloud on the child's board.



The email an adult receives

Analytics count repeats once, leave out adult modelling and messages marked as play, and show patterns by time of day, day of the week, setting and category. **AI**, on by default and switchable in Board settings, adds a labelled suggestion of what a message might mean, a daily insight and weekly summaries. It is capped at 60 interpretations per child per day; past the cap the board carries on exactly as before.

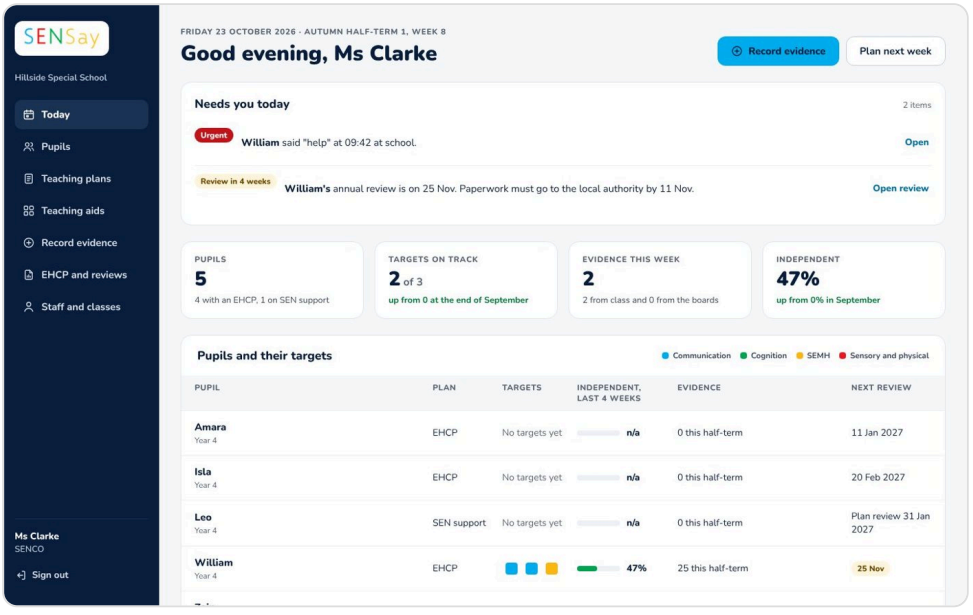
6 The family app

Page	Purpose
Home	Today, this week, the last message, the insight of the day, and the set-up checklist
Words and insights	Messages with "Was this right?" (Got it, Couldn't, Playing, Not sure), insights, and a weekly report as a PDF or a letter

Page	Purpose
Messages	The full log by setting, with urgent messages marked
Analytics	Most used, time of day, day of the week, routines and bursts
This week	Seven days at a glance with a weekly summary
From school	Targets, progress, the next review with the family's views, and therapy notes
Sharing	School link code; share with a therapist and choose what they see
Board settings	Layout, voice, vocabulary level, sections, AI switches
Child profile	The profile, documents read by AI and checked by the parent, and restrictions
Settings	Notifications by email and text, contacts with urgent-only, replies, account deletion

7 The school side

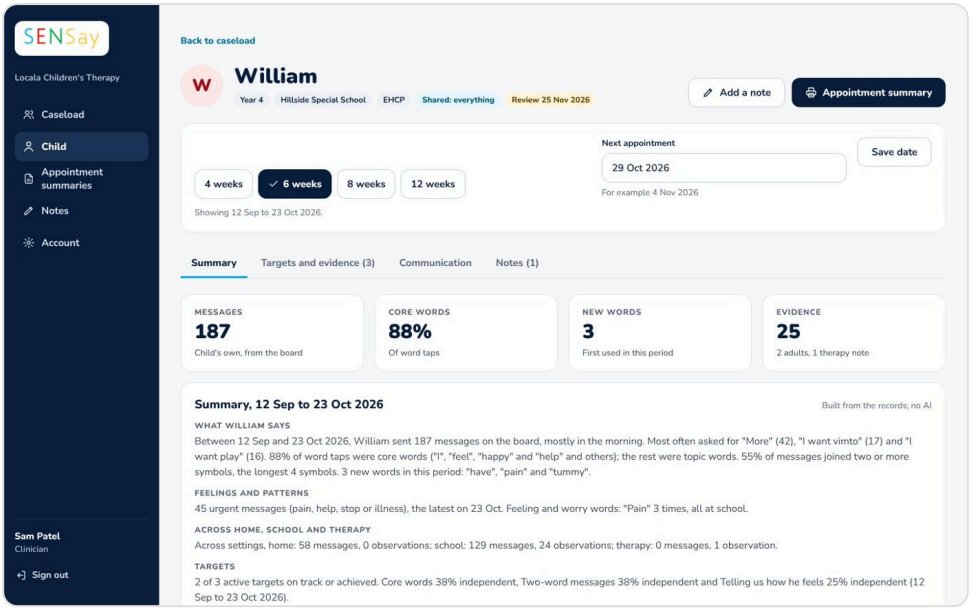
Page	Purpose
Today	Urgent messages, reviews coming up, targets short of evidence, with no AI
Pupils	Every pupil with plan, targets, evidence and next review
Pupil record	Targets and progress, evidence, communication, plan and documents, pupil profile
Record evidence	Full-screen capture in class, with the pupil's own words filled in, works offline
EHCP and reviews	Countdowns, the evidence pack with the pupil's and parent's views, PDF export, Section B drafts
Teaching aids	Ten aid types sent to a pupil's device, the class screen, or print
Teaching plans	Class and pupil plans, core words by week, lessons and shared boards
Staff and classes	Roles, invitations and classes



The school's Today page

8 The clinician side

Families share each child with a clinician by email, choosing everything or plans and progress only. The clinician sees a caseload of up to 40 children, a page per child (summary, targets and evidence, communication, notes), a printable appointment summary built only from counts in the record, and notes with advice for home and school that the family and school both see.



A child's page for the therapist

9 SENSay Connect

Connect is SENSay without our board, for AAC services and schools whose children use other devices. A team uploads each child's usage export; Connect keeps every upload, compares months, and shows the whole caseload.

System	Export Connect reads	Modelling separated
TD Snap (Tobii Dynavox)	myTobiiDynavox usage report (.xlsx)	Yes
Grid 3 (Smartbox)	The user's history.sqlite	No
TouchChat, LAMP Words for Life, Accent (PRC-Saltillo)	logFile.txt	No
CoughDrop	Open Board Logs (.obl)	Where recorded
Speak for Yourself	History (.csv)	No
Any other system	A spreadsheet of words used	If it has a column

Each child's page shows the steps for their own device. The caseload shows status (active, use dropping, not used for 14 days or more), eight weeks of use, and **Needs you this week**: children who have stopped, whose use has halved, whose target words are unused, or whose upload is out of date. A

printable **service summary** gives the share of devices in regular use and the share not used for 14 days, the measures NHS England asks specialised AAC services to report. Connect makes no AI calls.

10 Data, safety and trust

- **Where:** in the EU (Ireland), encrypted in transit and at rest, with access controls on every record.
- **Who sees what:** families own the record; schools see pupils linked by the family; clinicians see children shared with them; Connect teams see only their own caseload.
- **AI:** used only where it is labelled, with a daily limit per child. Outputs are always labelled as suggestions or drafts. No data is used to train models.
- **Children's Code:** no advertising, nothing to buy on the child's screen, and the adult gate on settings and edit mode.
- **Deletion:** a family can delete their account and everything in it.
- **Paperwork:** data processing agreement and impact assessment templates for schools; we are working through the NHS Data Security and Protection Toolkit, the Digital Technology Assessment Criteria and a clinical safety case.

11 Availability and prices

Area	Availability
The board	Free for every child at app.sensay.uk, and always will be
School side	Available now for schools, with founding school places for 2026 to 2027
Clinician side	Available now, for children whose families share them with you
SENSay Connect	Available now for AAC services, with a free 90-day trial for up to 40 children
Family plan	Available from January 2027
App Store and Google Play	2027

Prices for schools, families and clinicians are in the matching guides and at sensay.uk.

12 Where to find more

- **Guides:** for parents and carers, for teachers and SENCOs, for therapists, and the Connect guide for AAC services.
- **Try it:** app.sensay.uk, with demo accounts for a parent and a teacher.
- **Contact:** hello@sensay.uk for schools and services; support@sensay.uk for help.